

THE PAYSON MORNING SCROLL

MADE EXCLUSIVELY FOR THE MOGOLLON'S HEARTH GUESTS

"All the news worth knowing before the mead hall opens."

THE GREYBEARDS OF HIGH HROTHGAR — PUBLISHER & PROPRIETOR

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The Hearth's chicken, dancing in the afternoon rain — galoshes on, umbrella up.

SKIES O'ER THE HOLD

65° / 50°

PM showers

Sunrise 6:19 AM · Sunset 6:10 PM

Tomorrow — Sunny, 80/55

Overheard at the saloon: a traveler shook his fist at the rain and shouted "Clear Skies!" The barkeep swears the clouds near broke — "He was here not ten minutes ago."

AROUND THE HOLDS · THE WEEK AHEAD

Two Fairs, One Hold: Fair Week Rides Into Payson



By the Dude — Payson, Ariz.



Two fairs, one Hold: the North Inch Highland village and the County Fair's rodeo grounds beneath the Mogollon Rim.

HAIL, wayfarers, and welcome to the Hearth! The pines stand gold-tipped in the morning light, the chicken has donned her galoshes against an afternoon shower, and Payson braces for the grandest double-header of the season — two fairs in one Hold, four days of rodeo dust and Highland revelry. One more bit of news for the regulars: this Scroll now keeps its dates by the old Tamrielic reckoning — the bards' proper calendar — with the lowlanders' dates riding alongside so no traveler misses a thing; we stand at the close of Hearthfire (the lowlanders call it "September" — odd name for a month that smells of pine smoke!), with Frostfall but two days hence. By the Nine, it's a fine week to be in Rim Country.

HAPPENING IN THE HOLDS TODAY

-  **Payson**
 - **Morning at the Library** — Qi Gong 9 AM, Baby Story Time 10:30 AM, Tai Chi 11:30 AM, Payson Public Library — [monthly calendar](#)
 - **Bible Study** — 9–10 AM — [details](#)
-  **Camp Verde**
 - **Online Safety & Security** — 4–6 PM, Camp Verde Community Library; free hands-on class, bring thy device — [details](#)
 - **Common Cause Training** — 5–7 PM, Terracotta Room, Camp Verde Community Library — [library calendar](#)
-  **Show Low**
 - **BINGO!** — 3 PM, Pinetop-Lakeside; 15 games, \$15 buy-in, open to the public — [details](#)
-  **Prescott**
 - **Musicians with Heart Open Mic** — 7–10 PM, Jersey Lilly Saloon; donations go to the Yavapai County Food Bank — [details](#)

THE DAYS AHEAD

- **Fredas, 2nd of Frostfall (Oct. 2)**
 - **First Friday in the Galleries** — Sedona's monthly art evening runs 4–7 PM at Tlaquepaque Arts & Shopping Village. Gallery receptions, live music, and wine tastings, with the artists themselves on hand to talk about their work. A fine evening stroll as the Valley Dwellers trade the lowland heat for red-rock air. [details](#)
- **Loredas, 3rd of Frostfall (Oct. 3)**
 - **42nd Folk Music Festival** — the festival returns to the Sharlot Hall Museum (Prescott) after a seven-year rest, Saturday 9 AM–5 PM. More than 50 musicians across four stages, food trucks, a new Kid Zone, and a "Folk Fest Feast" area; admission \$15, kids 9 and under free — bring lawn chairs. Friday evening offers a limited-seating Folk Legacy Trio concert, 6–9 PM. [details](#)
 - **Pine-Strawberry Fall Festival & October Craft Show** — the Pine Strawberry Business Community fills the community center ramada (Pine) with handcrafts, Saturday 8 AM–5 PM and Sunday 8 AM–4 PM. Pumpkin patch and hayrides round out the fall tradition; grounds are alcohol- and smoke-free. [details](#)
 - **Twice Nice Fall Thrifty** — the thrift shop in Camp Verde hosts raffles and prizes for donated items, food trucks, and a live radio broadcast, 10 AM–2 PM. Sister duo Kaleidoscope Redrocks plays live noon–2, donating every tip to the Verde Valley Sanctuary. [details](#)
 - **Verde Valley Farmers Market** — the market closes its 2026 season Saturday, 8–11 AM in Camp Verde. One last morning of fresh local produce before the stalls sleep till spring — arrive hungry.
- **Tirdas, 6th of Frostfall (Oct. 6)**
 - **Trail Day Volunteer Build** — lend thy back to the PINE Strawberry Fuel Reduction crew, Tuesday 7 AM–noon, off Highway 87 just before Pine. Volunteers clear brush, move rocks, and shape new community trails; tools provided — bring water, sunscreen, gloves, and work shoes, and RSVP via the crew's Facebook event page. [details](#)

Two Fairs, One Hold



The North Inch faire raises its banners for the first time.

The North Inch Renaissance Faire holds its maiden voyage on the Payson Golf Course, Friday 9 AM–5 PM, Saturday 9 AM–9 PM, Sunday 9 AM–5 PM. A Scottish village rises on the fairways: artisans, combat demonstrations, axe throwing and archery, the Clan Armstrong fire-dancing show, the Queen of Scots' court, the Pirate Queen Scarlett McBayne, and the Queen of the Faeries. (A stranger came through town yesterday holding a queer device before him that wailed like a heartbroken mammoth and never once ran out of breath — a clever wind-spell doing the breathing for him. Other travelers have called it a “bagpipie.”)

Meanwhile the 72nd Annual Northern Gila County Fair & B.U.C.K.L.E. Festival holds court at the Payson Event Center, Thursday through Saturday. Professional bull riding, ranch rodeo, barrel racing, goat roping, mutton bustin', livestock shows and the Junior Livestock Auction, the Arizona State Fiddle Festival, live music, mini-carnival rides, and vendors — with Thursday evening's opening ceremony “Hailing Our Heroes” honoring veterans and hometown heroes.

North Inch: \$8 adults, \$4 children, active-duty military free — see northinchrf.com. County Fair: \$3–\$5 admission, \$5 parking — tickets via BAMM.

Why go: Two fairs, one Hold, and a weekend thy guests will talk about all winter — send them Friday for the jousts and Saturday for the bulls, and they'll owe thee a mug of mead.

QUESTS OF THE HEARTH

Quests awaiting:

- ☐ **Design & prep the torch sconces** — Overdue since Sept. 26 — measure the flame bulb and socket, then find or design the wall-torch sconce model.
- ☐ **Print the torch sconces** — Due Saturday, Oct. 3 — print two torches plus the socket test piece; test-fit the bulb and socket first.

The sconce design is overdue and the printing must fire by Saturday — the Hearth's torchlight waits on thee.



The craftsman at his bench, where the Hearth's torch sconces take shape.

MERCHANT OF THE HOLD

BoSa Donuts · Payson



Sweet rolls, fresh daily — the Hold's answer to the guards' favorite.

BoSa Donuts is a walk-in donut shop and bakery where the donuts are made fresh daily from scratch. The case holds the classics — glazed, chocolate iced, maple long johns, apple fritters, cinnamon twists, bear claws, and donut holes — plus breakfast sandwiches like sausage, egg & cheese on a croissant, coffee, cappuccino, and smoothies. Quick service with dine-in or drive-through, and the apple fritter is the thing the regulars swear by.

“Excellent donuts. The Apple Fritter was my absolute favorite. Crispy, crunchy glaze on the outside with perfectly cooked apples inside.” —

[TripAdvisor review](#)

Payson, along the Beeline Hwy — open daily from 5 AM; \$ inexpensive; drive-through, and the case is fullest in the morning. · [their website](#)

Why the Hearth sends you:

BoSa's apple fritter is the Hold's own sweet roll — and these come fresh daily with no guard in sight to confiscate them. A cheap, cheerful morning break along the Beeline, right as the Valley Dwellers roll into town for fair week.

TALES FROM THE TREELINE

FLURRY GILDS THE RAIN



The deck, gilded; Gus, grounded; the cakes, miraculously airborne.

It rained on Middas afternoon, the soft gray kind, and Flurry (a young ice-breathing dragon) took it as a personal invitation.

Nobody's quite sure whose idea it was — Henny (the Hearth's plump chicken) claims she only mentioned the rain looked “a mite plain” — but by mid-afternoon Flurry was perched on the Hearth's front deck, exhaling his finest ice-mist into the drizzle, gilding every falling drop into a tiny glittering jewel.

“I am gilding the rain,” he announced grandly, then landed sideways in a rain barrel for emphasis.

By the time Gus (a friendly orc with a baker's soul) came out with a tray of honey cakes, the whole deck sparkled like a kicked-over treasure chest. He took one step, skidded clean across the jewel-ice, and landed sitting down with the tray held high overhead — not one crumb lost.

“Save the cakes!” he bellowed, which is how Gus says “I'm fine.”

Mabel (a wood elf with the patience of a saint) surveyed the glittering deck, the dragon in the rain barrel, and the orc on his backside, and declared Flurry the Hold's first official weathermage.

Jethro (the Mogollon Monster) has already asked whether the weathermage can gild his bathwater. Mabel said no.